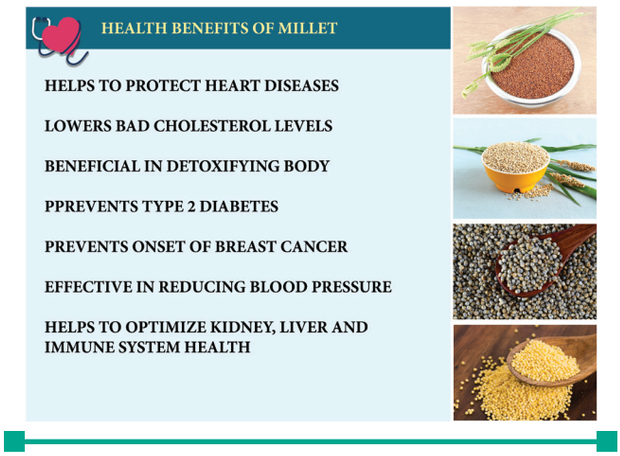
digestible grains available. Compared to rice, polished rice, millets release lesser percentage of glucose and over a longer period of time this lowers the risk of diabetes.



3.3.1 Types and Importance of Millets

Millets are particularly high in minerals like iron, magnesium, phosphorous and potassium, finger millet (ragi) is richest in calcium content.

Kinds of millets:

1.	Barnyard Millet	–	Kuthiravali
2.	Finger Millet	–	Ragi
3.	Foxtail Millet	–	Thinai
4.	Kodo Millet	–	Varagu
5.	Little Millet	–	Samai
6.	Pearl Millet	–	Kambu
7.	Proso Millet	–	Panivaragu
8.	Sorghum	–	Cholam

- Millets can be incorporated in our daily diet for almost all the meals and dishes. Breakfast items like porridge, dosa, idli, uppuma, puttu,ragi kali,- doughnuts, vadas, bonda, chapathis, pooris etc are some of the commonly prepared items.



Activity 1

List the Different kinds of millets available in the market

Activity 2

Formulate a recipe using millets

- Main meal items like ragi kali is highly nutritious.
- Millets can also lend themselves to the baking of cakes and biscuits as a 20% to 50% level of the cereal flour is being used and therefore enhance the nutritive value of the product. The nutritional content of millets is given in Table 2.

3.4 FOOD PYRAMID

Food pyramid is a visual tool that is used as a guide in designing diet. It is developed as a guide to provide a frame work for the types and amounts of food that can be eaten in combination to provide a healthy diet.

The Indian adaption of the food pyramid is divided into four levels

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